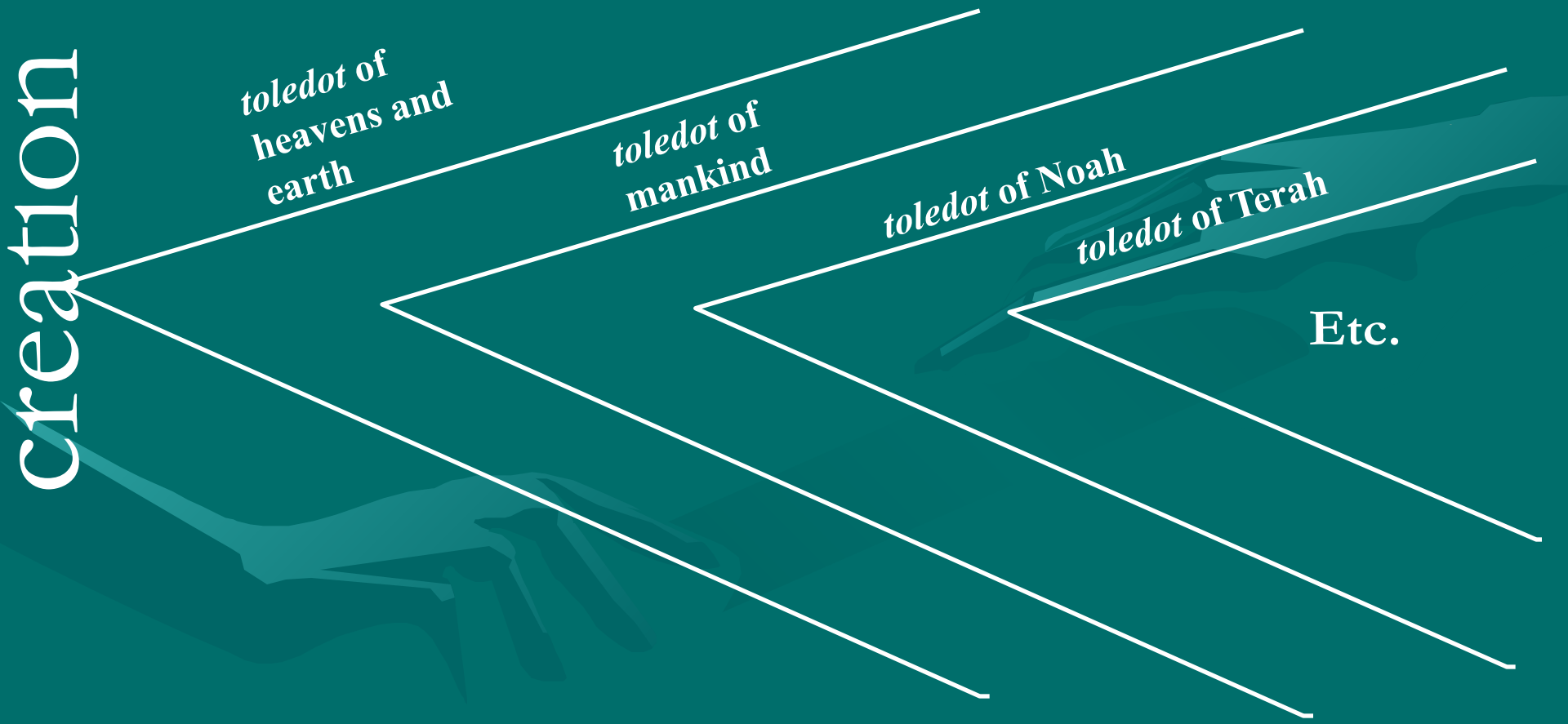
The Book of Humanity

The Book of the Toledot of Mankind

Genesis 5—11


creation
toledot of heavens and earth
toledot of mankind
toledot of Noah
toledot of Terah
Etc.

Background

1. Creation
2. What Happened to Creation
   - Adam, Eve, and the serpent
   - Adam, Eve, and Cain

Creation

God's Work

DEATH

Utltimate Vitality

Put into Man's Hands to finish

What Happened to Creation

- Man corrupted God's work

What Happened to Creation

What Happened to Creation

- Man corrupted God's work
- Man tried to be God
  - Seized the right to decide regarding self-interests
  - Condemned to death
  - Hope for life in future generations (Eve)
  - But future generations led to more death (Cain)
  - Hope for future life turned to God's provision of future generations (Enosh)

What Happened to Creation

- Summary

  Man failed to finish God's work . . .

  reversed God's creative work . . .

  which resulted in his own death.

  He looked to future generations as hope for life . . .

  but found only more death.

  But God provided hope for life in future generations for those who looked **to Him** for deliverance.

Continuation of the Story

1. Creation (Genesis 1)
2. What Happened to Creation (Genesis 2—4)
3. What Happened to Man (Genesis 5—11)
   - "This is the book of the generation of Adam"
4. "the book of the *toledot* of mankind"
   - Is this "just" a genealogy?
   - Where does it begin and end?

Genealogies

- Significance of genealogies as genre

  A comparative study of (1) modern oral genealogies, (2) ancient Near East king lists, and (3) biblical genealogies reveals . . .

  genealogies have both ***form*** and ***function***, and . . .

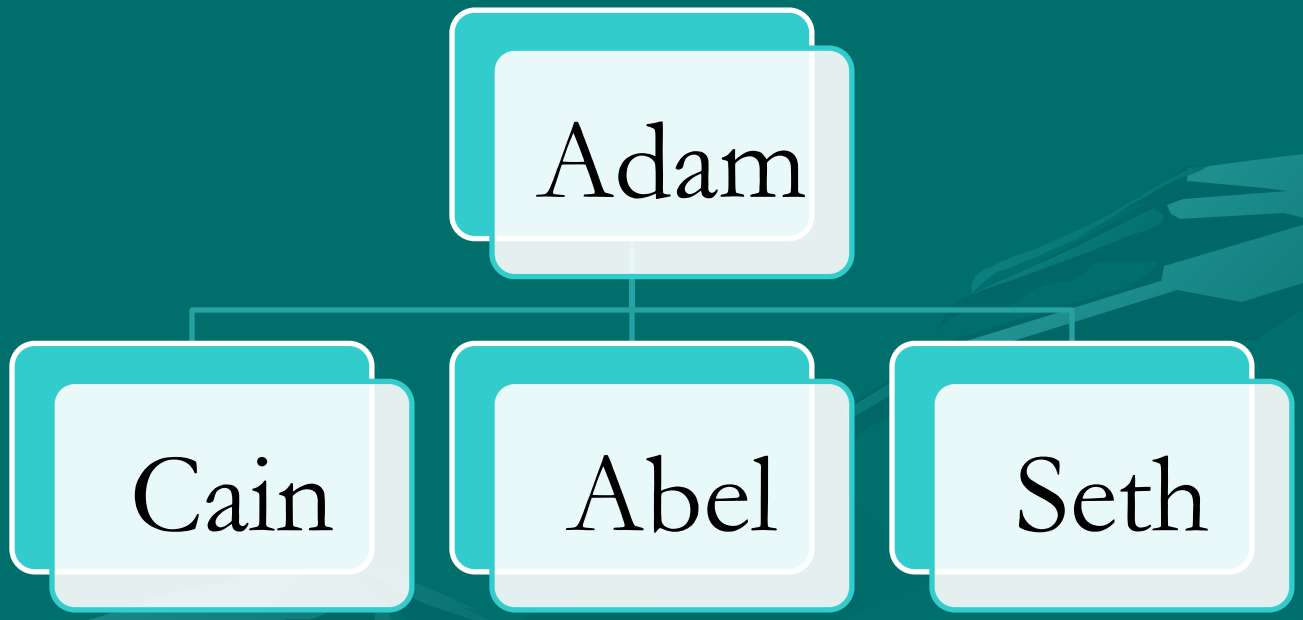
  form is related to ***function***

Genealogies

Form & Function

- Segmented genealogies
  - Form: listing multiple lines from an individual

Segmented Genealogy

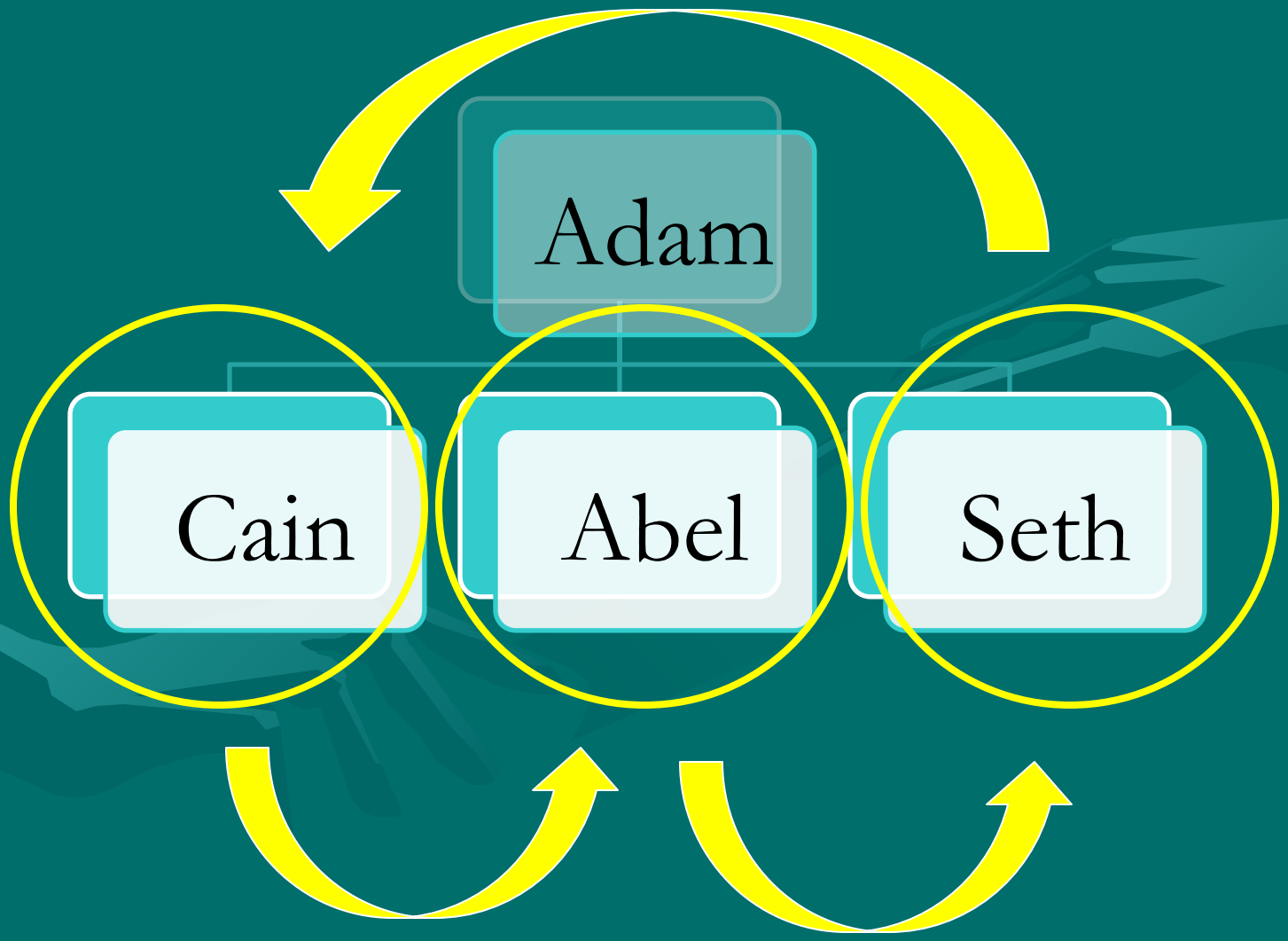


Genealogies

Form & Function

- Segmented genealogies
  - Form: listing multiple lines from an individual
  - Function: to show relationships

Segmented Genealogy



Genealogies

Form & Function

- Linear genealogies
  - Form: listing single line of descendants

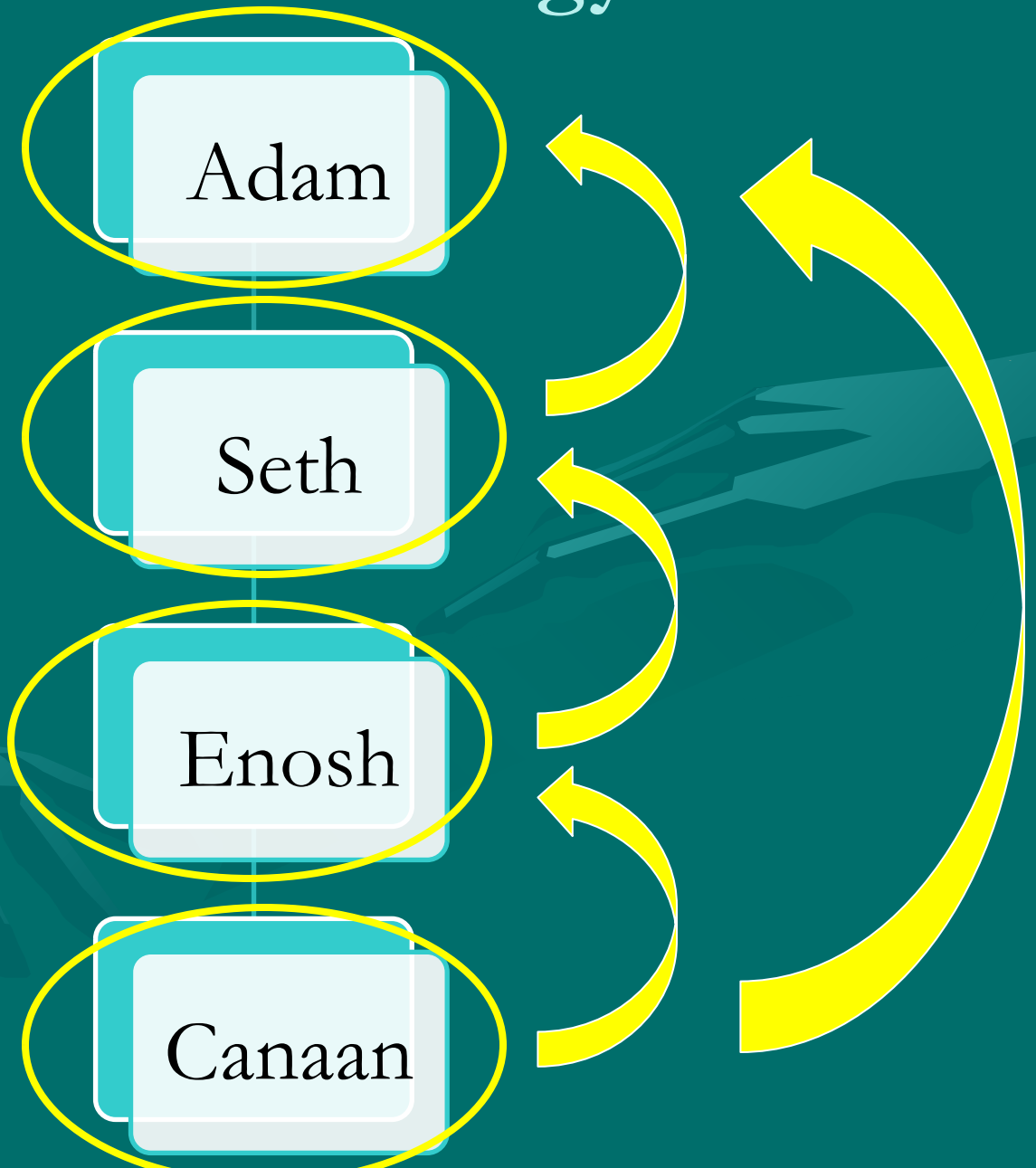
Linear Genealogy

Genealogies

Form & Function

- Linear genealogies
  - Form: listing single line of descendants
  - Function: relate a person to someone in the past

Linear Genealogy



Genesis 5 Genealogy

- **Significance** of the form
  - A linear genealogy
    - with narrative insertions (Enoch & Lamech)
      - more to come
  - showing each individual is connected to Adam
- But what kind of connection is presented??

Genesis 5 Genealogy

- **Detailed** form of mankind's genealogy
  - PN_1 (*personal name*) lived x years and begat PN_2.
  - PN_1 lived after he begat PN_2 y years
  - and begat sons and daughters.
  - All the days of PN_1 were z years;
  - and he died.

Genesis 5 Genealogy

- **Significance** of the form
  - PN_1 (*personal name*) lived x years and begat PN_2. ← **New Information?**
  - PN_1 lived after he begat PN_2 y years ← **New Information?**
  - and begat sons and daughters. ← **New Information?**
  - All the days of PN_1 were z years; ← **New Information?**
  - and he died. ← **New Information?**

Why the repetition??

Genesis 5 Genealogy

Emphasizes death!

All who are related to Adam die!

But where does it end??

Genesis 5—11

Genealogy Forms: Adam vs. Shem

- PN_1 lived x years and begat PN_2.
- PN1 lived x years and begat PN_2.
- PN_1 lived after he begat PN_2 y years
- PN1 lived after he begat PN_2 y years
- and begat sons and daughters.
- and begat sons and daughters.
- All the days of PN_1 were z years;
- …
- and he died
- …

Genesis 5—11

Genealogy Forms: Adam vs. Shem

- PN_1 lived x years and begat PN_2.
- PN1 lived x years and begat PN2.
- PN1 lived after he begat PN2 y years
- PN1 lived after he begat PN2 y years
- and begat sons and daughters.
- and begat sons and daughters.
- All the days of PN_1 were z years;
- …
- and he died
- …

But why the change??

Genesis 5—11

Genealogy Forms: Adam vs. Shem

- Adam's genealogy emphasizes death
- Shem's genealogy eliminates that emphasis.
- Again, why the change?
- What happens in between the two genealogies?

Genesis 5—11

Between Adam's & Shem's Genealogy

- The story of the flood occurs
- But the story of the flood is actually a narrative insertion into the Noah entry of the genealogy

Genesis 5—11

Comparison of Forms: Adam vs. Noah

- PN_1 lived x years and begat PN_2.
- Noah was 500 years old and begat Shem, Ham, Japheth (5:32)
  (*flood narrative, introducing the toledot of Noah*)
- PN_1 lived after he begat PN_2 y years
- Noah lived after the flood 350 years (9:28)
- and begat sons and daughters.
- . . .
- All the days of PN_1 were z years;
- All the days of Noah were 950 years (9:29)
- and he died
- and he died

Genesis 5—11

Between Adam's & Shem's Genealogy

- The narrative insert is very large and thus very significant.
- Its significance of this insert is revealed by its structure.

Genesis 5—11

of Generations

Before and After the Noah Entry

- 10 generations before and after the Noah entry.
- Genealogies of 10 generations represented an ideal pattern in ancient ANE listings.

Noah Entry

- The ***importance*** of the Noah entry
  - the fact that it ***is*** a narrative insertion into a genealogy,
  - the ***change*** in overall genealogical pattern before and after the account,
  - and, the placement of ***10*** generations before and after the account.
- Exegetical Implications
  - extremely important to the message of the entire section,
  - somehow explains the removal of the focus on death

Genesis 5—11

Flood Account

- The **internal structure** of the flood account provides further clues as to its significance.
  - Chiastic Structure
  - Crescendo-Decrescendo
  - De-creation—Re-creation

Genesis 5—11

Flood Account

- Chiastic Structure

Genesis 5—11

A Transitional introduction (6:9-10)
- B Violence in God's creation (6:11-12)
  - C First divine address: resolution to destroy (6:13-22)
    - D Second divine address: command to enter the ark (7:1-10)
      - E Beginning of Flood (7:11-16)
        - F The rising flood waters (7:17-24)
          - **X God's remembrance of Noah**
        - F' The receding flood waters (8:1-5)
      - E' The drying of the earth (8:6-14)
    - D' Third divine address: command to leave the ark (8:15-19)
  - C' God's resolution to preserve order (8:20-22)
- B' Fourth divine address: covenant blessing and peace (9:1-17)

A' Transitional conclusion (9:18-19)

Genesis 5—11

Flood Account

- Crescendo-Decrescendo Presentation

Genesis 5—11

Crescendo

- 7:1-5 simply rain
- 7:6-10 flood of waters
- 7:11-16 cosmic terminology
  the windows of heavens
  the fountains of the deep.
- 7:17-24
  the flood was on the earth,
  the waters increased,
  the waters prevailed and increased greatly,
  the mountains were covered,
  all flesh died,
  the waters prevailed 150 days

Genesis 5—11

Decrescendo

- 8:2 fountains of the deep & the windows of heaven close, the rain stops
- 8:3-4 waters slowly abate (150 days), and the ark rests on Ararat
- 8:5 waters continue to abate, tops of mountains become visible
- 8:6-12 waters continue to abate, birds gradually leave
- 8:13 waters are dried up and ground surface is dry
- 8:14 the earth is dry

Genesis 5—11

Flood Account

- De-creation—Re-creation Presentation

Genesis 5—11

Reversal of Creation

Creation	The Flood
Waters above and waters below separated	Destruction in the following order: man, animals, creeping things, birds
Waters restricted and dry land appears	Waters released and dry land disappears
Creation in the following order: birds, animals, creeping things, man	Waters above and waters below combined

Genesis 5—11

Re-Creation as an Allusion to Creation

Creation	Post-flood Re-Creation
Prelude signaled by the activity of the Spirit	Prelude signaled by the activity of the Spirit/wind
Waters restrained and dry land appears	Waters restrained and dry land appears
Earth populated by living creatures and man	Earth populated by living creatures and man
Man presented as the image of God	Man presented as the image of God
Conclusion with a blessing on man	Conclusion with a blessing on man

Genesis 5—11

Flood Account

- Summary of Internal and External Structure

Genesis 5—11

Chapter 5

PN_1 lived x years and begat PN_2.
PN_1 lived after he begat PN_2 y years and begat sons and daughters.
All the days of PN_1 were z years; and he died.

Chapter 11

PN_1 lived x years and begat PN_2.
PN_1 lived after he begat PN_2 y years and begat sons and daughters.
~~All the days of PN_1 were z years; and he died.~~

God remembered Noah

de-creation crescendo

re-creation decrescendo

chiasm

ten generations

flood narrative

ten generations